

Meditations

Marcus Aurelius

Book One

From my grandfather Verus I learned good morals and the government of my temper. From the reputation and remembrance of my father, modesty and a manly character. From my mother, piety and beneficence, and abstinence, not only from evil deeds, but even from evil thoughts.

Book Two

Begin the morning by saying to thyself, I shall meet with the busybody, the ungrateful, arrogant, deceitful, envious, unsocial. All these things happen to them by reason of their ignorance of what is good and evil. The best kind of revenge is not to become like your enemy.

Book Three

We ought to consider not only that our life is daily wasting away and a smaller part of it is left, but another thing also must be taken into account, that if a man should live longer, it is quite uncertain whether the understanding will still continue sufficient.

Book Four

The universe is change; our life is what our thoughts make it. Take away thy opinion, and then there is taken away the complaint. That which has died falls not out of the universe. If it stays here, it also changes here, and is dissolved into its proper parts.

Book Five

In the morning when thou risest unwillingly, let this thought be present: I am rising to the work of a human being. Why then am I dissatisfied if I am going to do the things for which I exist and for which I was brought into the world?

Book Six

The best way of avenging thyself is not to become like the wrongdoer. Look within. Within is the fountain of good, and it will ever bubble up, if thou wilt ever dig. Death is a cessation of the impressions through the senses.